

Assessment Brief: Operational Planning • V1.0

KEY INFORMATION FOR LEARNERS

Overview of assessment tasks

Each task in this assessment brief has been developed to enable you to evidence achievement of the learning outcomes and Assessment Criteria for **CMI HTQ Unit 553: Operational Planning**. Each of the Assessment Criteria must gain a pass outcome for you to successfully achieve the unit.

Preparation for the assessment

- Please read the **CMI HTQ Unit 553: Operational Planning** specification thoroughly as only the content related to the achievement of the Assessment Criteria will be assessed.
- Research the topics being assessed. Suggested reading/web resources are provided in the **CMI HTQ Unit 553: Operational Planning** specification. Your tutor may signpost you to relevant resources. Additionally, you may access excellent online resources at ManagementDirect <https://members.md.cmi.org.uk>
- Please read the definitions of the command verbs used in the Assessment Criteria (e.g. evaluate, discuss, analyse) at <https://www.managers.org.uk/wp-content/uploads/2020/03/Command-Verb-Definitions.pdf>

Completing the assessment brief

- The assessment brief contains a series of tasks which are clearly referenced to the relevant Assessment Criteria.
- Refer to the Assessment Guidance Table at the end of the assessment brief which outlines the requirements for a Pass or Refer.
- Evidence for assessment must be presented in the Assessment Booklet or other suitable format.
- If work based evidence is used, such as plans or documentation (which has been referred to within the main text, it should be included in the 'Work Based Evidence' section in the Assessment Booklet
- Appendices are not a requirement of this assessment brief. If appendices are included these will not be marked or moderated by CMI.
- Work based evidence, where included, must not exceed SIX (6) pages. All evidence should be combined within the Assessment Booklet.
- Any assessment templates that have been created to support this unit are located in the Assessment Booklet.
- The Assessment Booklet must be completed in a professional manner (for example applying business conventions for writing formal reports) and by using Microsoft Word, Rich Text Format or another compatible software programme.
- The Assessment Booklet must be saved as a word document (.doc or .docx) and not in a PDF format.
- An appropriate referencing system (such as Harvard Referencing) must be used to ensure the original source(s) of quotations or models can be verified. Please refer to Reference and Citations Study guide at <https://www.managers.org.uk/~media/Files/PDF/Study%20Support/References-and-Citations.pdf>
- Finally, you must complete and sign the Learner Statement of Authenticity (an electronic signature is accepted)

Learner support

For information regarding policies and procedures for assessment (for example reasonable adjustments, learner support, appeals, complaints, certification, confidentiality, plagiarism) you should contact your tutor or Centre manager and refer to the CMI Level 5 Diploma in Operational Management syllabus.

ASSESSMENT BRIEF: HTQ UNIT 553 - OPERATIONAL PLANNING

Assessment brief CMI HTQ Unit 553 has been designed to facilitate learners in demonstrating their proficiency in translating organisational objectives into operational plans, thereby enriching the strategic planning process. This assessment emphasises both theoretical insights and practical applications involved in formulating and executing an operational plan. Furthermore, it underscores the significance of possessing the requisite knowledge, skills, and behaviours essential for monitoring the quality and outcomes aligned with the plan, and adeptly reporting on the findings. Upon successful completion of this assessment, operational or departmental managers will gain a heightened appreciation for the intricacies of operational planning and its pivotal role in organisational success.

ASSESSMENT TASKS AND WORD COUNT

Assessment brief **CMI HTQ Unit 553** features the following assessment tasks. Further detail is provided against each assessment task within the brief.

Assessment Task		Learning outcomes covered by assessment method	Assessment Criteria	L5 ODM KSB	Guideline word count
1	Write an report titled ' <i>The principles of operational planning</i> '	LO1 Understand the principles of operational planning in an organisation	1.1 Assess the relationship between an organisation's strategic objectives and operational planning	K1 K2	Approx. 2500 words
			1.2 Evaluate the use of approaches to operational planning		
		LO2 Know how to create an effective operational plan	2.1 Assess methods of managing and leading the delivery of an operational plan	K3 K18	
			2.2 Review techniques for problem solving and decision making	K19	
			2.3 Assess the ethical requirements that influence an operational plan	K20	
2	Create an Operational Plan covering a minimum of three months	LO3 Be able to manage and lead the delivery of an operational plan	3.1 Create an operational plan in line with organisational objectives	K1 K3 K18 K19	Approx. 1500 words
		LO4 Be able to monitor and measure the outcome of operational planning	4.1 Evaluate methods used to monitor progress and measure the outcomes of operational plans	S1 S3, S4 S5, S6 S15 S16	

			4.2 Examine the impact of legal and organisational factors on an operational plan	B1, B2 B3, B5 B4	
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Guideline word count

The written word, whether generated and/or recorded, is expected to form the majority of assessable work produced by Learners at Level 5. The amount and volume of written work for this unit should be broadly comparable to a word count of **4000** words for Tasks 2 and 3, within a margin of +/-10%. Excessive use of word count is not grounds for referral, however, the CMI reserves the right to return work to the Centre for editing and resubmission by the Learner.

The following are excluded from the written word count: Index or contents pages, headings and subheadings, diagrams, charts and graphs, bibliography.

If you require further guidance on assessment, please ask your centre to refer to [CMI's Quality Assurance Handbook](#).

THE PRINCIPLES OF OPERATIONAL PLANNING

The ability to translate organisational objectives into operational plans is an essential management skill. This assessment task has been written to enable operational or departmental managers to evidence their understanding of the strategic direction of the organisation and how to contribute to the strategic planning process.

TASK 1

Write a **report** titled '*The Principles of operational planning*'

The **report** should be in 5 (FIVE) parts:

1. Assessment of the relationship between an organisation's strategic objectives and operational planning (AC1.1)
2. Evaluation of the approaches used in operational planning (AC1.2)
3. Assessment of the methods of managing and leading the delivery of an operational plan (AC2.1)
4. Review of the techniques for problem solving and decision making (AC2.2)
5. Assessment of the ethical requirements that influence an operational plan (AC2.3)

Guidance for completion of Task 1

- *The report should include appropriate sub headings to organise the content clearly. You may choose to include tables and diagrams (as appropriate, but avoid over-reliance on these visual aids). Ensure all tables and diagrams are clearly labelled and indicate their sources.*
- *Your discussion should be underpinned with relevant theoretical principles and references to relevant models and frameworks.*
- *You may include good practice examples from an organisation you know well or have researched and are familiar with.*
- *Please refer to the indicative content for each Assessment Criteria outlined in the unit specification.*
- *Word limit will be 2,500 words (+/- 10% at the apprentice's discretion) excluding tables, graphs, figures, references and annexes*

CREATING AN EFFECTIVE OPERATIONAL PLAN

Creating an operational plan provides a roadmap for achieving strategic objectives efficiently and effectively. This assessment task has been written to enable operational or departmental managers to evidence the skills and behaviours required to form a well-crafted operational plan that enables organisations to optimise their use of time, money, and personnel to drive organisational performance, foster growth, and ensure long-term sustainability.

Monitoring and measuring the effectiveness of an operational plan is paramount to the success and sustainability of an organisation. This assessment task has been written to enable operational or departmental managers to evidence the skills, knowledge and behaviours of providing valuable insight into whether the plan is being executed as intended and whether the desired outcomes are being achieved.

TASK 2

Create an **Operational Plan** in line with organisational objectives, the plan should cover a minimum of three months.

Your **Operational Plan** should address the following:

- **Introduction:** This section provides background information about the organisation, its mission, vision, and goals
- **Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):** Define the metrics or indicators that will be used to measure progress and success in achieving the operational objectives (AC 3.1)
- **Operational Strategies:** Detail the specific strategies and tactics that will be employed to accomplish the objectives outlined in the plan (AC 3.1)
- **Action Plan:** Break down the strategies into actionable steps or tasks, assigning roles and responsibilities, deadlines, and resources required for each task (AC 3.1)
- **Resource Allocation:** Identify and allocate the resources (such as human, financial, technological) necessary to implement the operational strategies effectively (AC 3.1)
- **Risk Management Plan:** Identify and assess potential risks and challenges that may arise during the implementation of the operational plan, and outline mitigation strategies to address them (AC 3.1)
- **Timeline:** Provide a timeline or schedule for the implementation of the operational plan, including milestones and deadlines for key activities (AC 3.1)
- **Budget:** Detail the financial resources required to implement the operational plan, including revenue projections, expenses, and budget allocations for different activities (AC 3.1)
- **Contingency Plan:** Outline alternative courses of action that can be taken if certain objectives are not met or if unforeseen circumstances arise (AC 3.1)
- **Communication Plan:** Specify how information will be communicated both internally and externally regarding the operational plan, including key messages, stakeholders, and communication channels (AC 3.1)
- **Monitoring and Evaluation:** Evaluate methods used to monitor progress and measure the outcomes, including the frequency of review and the mechanisms for feedback and adjustment considering the advantages and disadvantages, associated issues, challenges and limitations of the methods (AC 4.1)
- **Legal and Organisational Factors:** Examine the impact these factors (such as employment laws, GDPR, and industry regulations and compliance requirements, organisational culture, structure and power dynamics, leadership styles, resource availability, internal policies and procedures, risk appetite and internal relationships) on the operational plan (AC 4.2)
- **Conclusion:** Summarise the key points of the operational plan and reiterate its importance in achieving the organisation's goals (AC 3.1)

Guidance for completion of Task 2

- You are encouraged to consider the use of well chosen examples from an organisation you know well or have researched and familiar with.
- Use the CMI template to create an **operational plan** for a minimum of three months.
- The operational plan must be in line with organisational objectives.
- The operational plan may be based on work experience, and can link to an area of work that you are familiar with, or have researched thoroughly.
- The operational plan must show a clear link to organisational objectives and be based on one area of work.
- You are **not required** to include every piece of legislation, organisational policy and procedure in your plan, you should focus on those you feel are essential to operational planning.
- If required, the CMI template can be adapted or extended.
- The plan may be presented in a format of your choice or using the CMI template provided, ensuring that all Assessment Criteria are addressed.
- Please refer to the indicative content for each Assessment Criteria outlined in the unit specification.
- Word limit will be 1,500 words (+/- 10% at the Learners discretion) excluding tables, graphs, figures, references and annexes.

ASSESSMENT GUIDANCE

Refer	Pass
• Not all Assessment Criteria have been met • No examples were used or the examples given do not match the requirements of the Assessment Criteria • Evidence is - • Unclear • Technically incorrect or inaccurate • Biassed • Includes unprofessional language • Poorly structured and presented • Lacks sufficient detail to show understanding of the topic • The application of different theories or approaches is incorrect, unclear or inappropriate • Evidence is not directly attributable to the learner • Evidence of plagiarism, collusion, cheating • External sources of information are not acknowledged • Work based evidence does not meet the requirements of the Assessment Criteria and the occupational standard, and are not current (within the period of the technical education or apprenticeship programme)	• All Assessment Criteria have been met • Examples given are well chosen and match the requirements of the Assessment Criteria • Evidence is - • Well written and presented • Contains a breadth of examples • Accurate • Current • Authentic • Inclusive • Coherent • Credible • Technically correct • Evidence shows understanding of different theories or approaches, is clear and appropriate • Evidence used from external sources has been correctly cited and referenced • Evidence is directly attributable to the learner • Work based evidence does meet the requirements of the Assessment Criteria and the occupational standard, and are current (within the period of the technical education or apprenticeship programme)